

# Round 6 — Spa-Francorchamps

Ferrari 458 Italia GT3 | Gran Turismo 7 | BOP: ON

## ■ RACE SPECIFICATIONS

| Parameter | Value                | Parameter      | Value                |
|-----------|----------------------|----------------|----------------------|
| Duration  | 60 minutes           | Grid           | Reverse              |
| Tyre Wear | 4x                   | Start          | Rolling              |
| Fuel      | 3x                   | Tuning         | Brake Balance only   |
| Weather   | Random / Rain chance | Qualifying     | 10 min — Must use RS |
| Pit Rules | As necessary         | Tyre Allowance | RM RH RS IM WET      |

## ■ SITUATION ASSESSMENT

Critical threats at 4x wear on this car:

| Corner                | Threat                                                                         |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Eau Rouge / Raidillon | MR compression loads rear hard every lap. Classic Ferrari rear sensitivity.    |
| Pouhon                | Sustained lateral load degrades right-rear. Progressive handling helps manage. |
| La Source exit        | MR oversteer on exit. The 458 communicates well — listen to it.                |
| Bus Stop chicane      | Braking instability on worn tyres. MR snap risk.                               |

Reverse grid rolling start = fighting through traffic. Protect the car early, do not chase lap times in Lap 1-3.

## ■ QUALIFYING PLAN — 10 min | Mandatory RS

- Out-lap: build tyre temps gently — do NOT push through Eau Rouge cold
- Flying lap 1: clean banker. No heroics. Get a time on the board.
- Flying lap 2: PUSH — RS peaks on lap 2 at Spa at 4x wear
- Lap 3: no meaningful improvement. Box and prepare tyre switch.
- Final sector: Blanchimont flat if confident. Bus Stop precise — don't ruin a clean lap.

You have 1 minute before race start to change compound. Switch to RM.

## ■ RACE STRATEGY — STINT PLAN

| Stint       | Tyre                 | Target Duration | Pit Lap Target | Notes                                                |
|-------------|----------------------|-----------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1           | RM                   | ~20–22 min      | Lap 10–11      | Manage rear in traffic. Do not push until clear air. |
| 2           | RM or RH             | ~20–22 min      | Lap 21–22      | Weather read. RH if tyre wear felt severe.           |
| 3 (if req.) | IM / WET / Remaining |                 | —              | Weather dependent. React early.                      |

■ Do NOT start on RS. At 4x wear, RS dies in 15–18 min at Spa. RM is mandatory race start.

■ Two-stop is very possible. Be mentally prepared before the race.

## ■ FUEL PLAN — 3x Multiplier

| Condition                     | Fuel Map | Reason                             |
|-------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|
| Normal running, clear air     | Map 4    | Standard — no sacrifice needed     |
| Stuck in traffic, no overtake | Map 3    | Save without hurting race position |
| Fuel short risk only          | Map 2    | Last resort — costs real lap time  |

Two stops with Map 4 throughout should be sufficient. Do not overthink fuel — tyres are the priority.

## ■ WEATHER PROTOCOL — This Decides the Race

| Condition                      | Action                                               |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Stays dry throughout           | RM → RM (two stops)                                  |
| Heavy rain starts during stint | Box IMMEDIATELY for WET — do not wait                |
| Light rain / drying line       | Stay on RM until dangerous, then IM                  |
| Rain starts between stints     | Take IM (not WET) — easier to manage on drying track |
| Drying in Stint 2 or 3         | IM → RM when dry racing line forms                   |

*At Spa, getting caught on slicks in heavy rain costs 30+ seconds. React early, not late.*

## ■ BRAKE BALANCE PLAN

| Phase                    | Setting  | Reason                                             |
|--------------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Race start (traffic)     | -2 to -3 | Front bias for predictable stops                   |
| Mid-race (clear air)     | -1 to -2 | Neutral as grip builds                             |
| Final stint (worn tyres) | 0 to -1  | Worn tyres — keep front-biased, rear is going away |

■ NEVER go positive. MR layout already rotates under braking. Positive bias = snap oversteer at La Source or Bus Stop.

## ■ KEY DRIVING NOTES — CORNER BY CORNER

### EAU ROUGE / RAIDILLON

- Complete braking before entry — no trail braking through compression
- Smooth throttle over crest. 458 gives warning before snap — heed it.
- Full commitment required

### LA SOURCE

- Trail brake gently to rotate — 458 responds progressively
- Throttle modulation on exit — right-rear is vulnerable all race
- On worn tyres: extra patience, the 458 will tell you when it's done

### POUHON

- Right-rear wears here every lap. Budget for it.
- Smooth inputs, the 458 rewards consistency
- On worn tyres: carry less speed, preserve rubber

### BUS STOP CHICANE

- MR instability under braking — keep front-biased
- 458's progressive handling helps through direction changes
- Don't push on worn tyres — the warning signs come late here

### BLANCHIMONT

- Flat on fresh tyres
- 458 communicates well — you'll feel when to lift
- If in doubt, lift.

### OVERTAKING ZONES:

- End of Kemmel Straight into Les Combes — best opportunity of the lap
- Out-braking into La Source from long straight — commit early or don't try
- Bus Stop chicane — high risk, last resort only

## ■ WHAT WILL LOSE THE RACE

|   |                             |                                                                         |
|---|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Starting on RS              | Dead in 15-18 min. Early pit destroys all reverse-grid progress.        |
| 2 | Ignoring weather            | Staying on slicks in rain at Spa is race-ending. React early.           |
| 3 | Ignoring car's feedback     | 458 communicates degradation. Ignoring it leads to sudden loss of grip. |
| 4 | Positive brake balance      | Classic MR snap risk. Keep it front-biased.                             |
| 5 | Pitting too late on worn RM | You lose more time in the last 3 laps than you save avoiding the stop.  |

## ■ SIMPLE EXECUTION SUMMARY

QUALIFY RS → 2 flying laps → box

PRE-RACE Switch to RM in the 1-minute window

LAP 1-3 Survive traffic. No risks. Protect rears.

LAP 4-9 Find rhythm. Manage Pouhon and La Source exits.

LAP 10-11 PIT. Fresh RM (or RH if wear felt severe).

WEATHER Any rain signal → react immediately – don't wait

STINT 2 Push in clean air. Blanchimont flat on fresh rubber only.

FINAL STINT Rear protection mode. Brake balance to 0 or -1.

WIN ON CONSISTENCY.